29 Sep 2026 04:05:50 ET | 15 pages

China Auto Manufacturers

Weichai-Sinotruk/CAT/CMI Tracker: Gap Widens to Record 35%, Matching Jun's Widest Level

CITI'S TAKE

We estimate that YTD Weichai's share price was on average 13.3% below our AIDC/SOFC/AI weighted index, with 1SD at 9.6ppt (Figure 1). Currently, Weichai is 35% below the AIDC/SOFC/AI index (matching the widest gap level since Jun), versus 28% below the index a week ago, indicating that the ST risk-reward on Weichai is relatively attractive again given its share price-to-AIDC/AI index gap widening to -2.3 SD below the YTD average, with the potential upcoming catalyst of the shipment kick-start of overseas AIDC gas engines coming from late Sep-26. **Latest trend of AIDC/Yield/Oil (Figure 2):** The US 10-year treasury yield and WTI spot oil price both increased by +0.29ppt and +1% over the past week, which weighed on our AI index that declined -2%.

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Further readings:

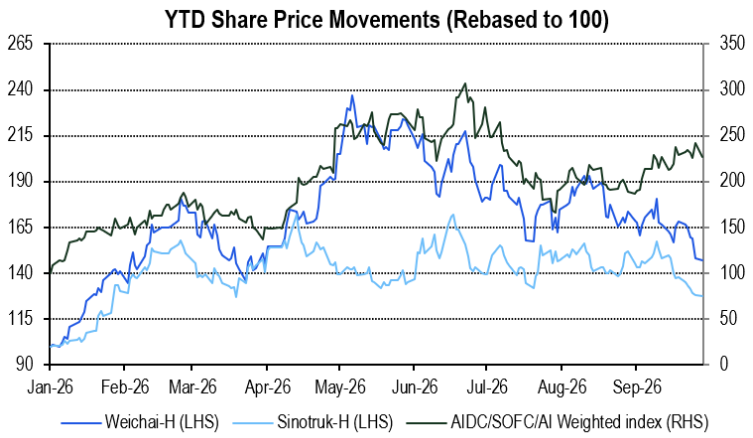
(1) Weichai Power (2338.HK) - Double-checking the GNRC-AMZN deal again; AIDC Gas Engine Ramp more a 4Q26 Catalyst

(2) Sinotruk (Hong Kong) (3808.HK): 2Q Analyst Briefing: Exports Power On, NEV HDT on Path to Breakeven

(3) China Auto Manufacturers - Aug-26 CV/HDT Sales Summary

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

Figure 1. YTD Share Price Movements of Weichai/Sinotruk/Generac/BE

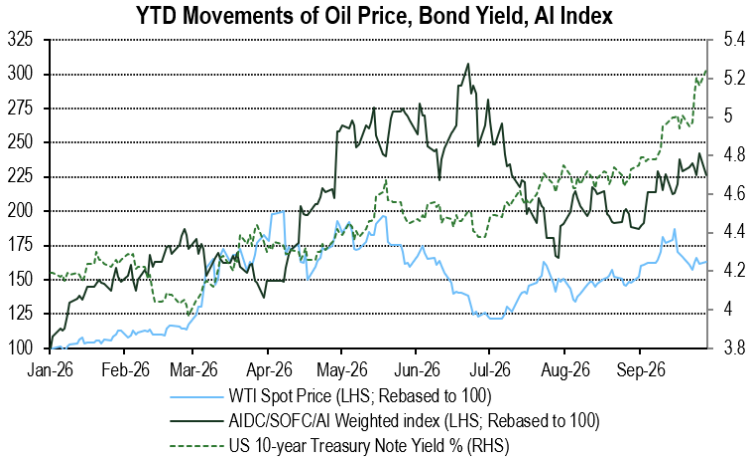


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Note: We recognize Weichai's share price has been driven by AI momentum. We developed an AIDC/SOFC/AI-Hardware weighted index, by assigning 50%/50% weight on daily share prices of Generac/Bloom Energy.

Source: Citi Research Estimates, Bloomberg

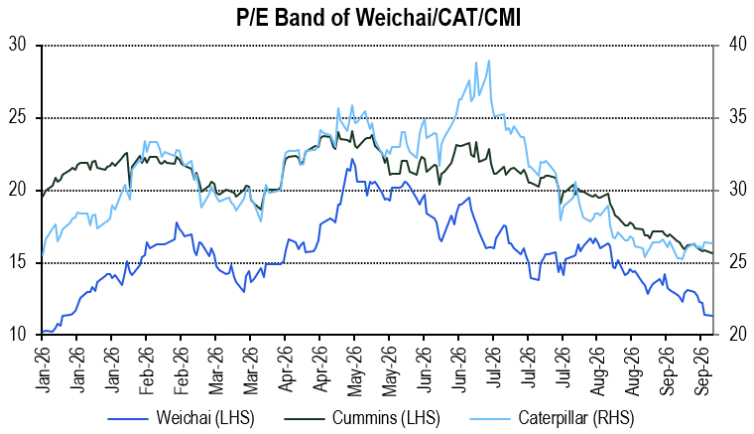
Figure 2. YTD Movements of Oil Price, Bond Yield, AI Index



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Source: Citi Research Estimates, Bloomberg, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System (US) via FRED, US EIA

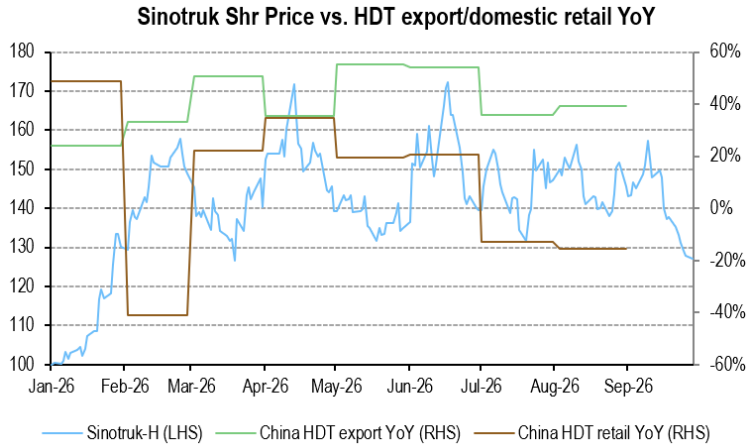
Figure 3. P/E Band of Weichai/CAT/CMI



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Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 4. Sinotruk Share Price vs. China HDT Export/Domestic Retail YoY



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Source: Citi Research, CAAM, Thinkercar

Caterpillar Inc

(CAT.N; US$819.95; 1; 28 Sep 26; 16:00)

Valuation

Our $1,100 target price uses a ~35.5x P/E on our 2027E EPS estimate. We think that over the last decade, CAT has become a more disciplined company, not overbuilding capacity during upcycles, focusing on organic investment in profitable growth, and returning cash to shareholders. Additionally, CAT's customers in many of its key end-markets are displaying greater capital discipline than they have historically, which suggests more stable demand for CAT going forward. This informs our view that CAT can sustain higher through-cycle margins, reduced earnings volatility, and higher/more consistent cash return to shareholders than it has historically, which we think justifies a higher multiple vs. CAT's historical average.

Risks

As a global company exposed to changes in macro conditions, a slowdown in global growth is the most obvious risk to CAT. In addition, risks to our target price include: 1) fluctuations in the growth outlook for China, which is ~40% of global metals demand and, thus, heavily impacting miner profitability; 2) deterioration in key commodity prices like oil, copper, and iron ore; and 3) changes in F/X levels, as this can influence CAT's competitive positioning against certain of its non-US competitors. If these risks prove to have less of an impact on Caterpillar than we believe, the stock could surpass our target price. On the other hand, a harder impact from the risks listed above could cause the stock to fail to reach our target price.

Cummins Inc

(CMI.N; US$517.84; 1; 28 Sep 26; 16:00)

Valuation

Our $790 target price reflects a ~23x P/E multiple on our 2027E EPS. This is above its historical average, reflecting our strong earnings growth expectations for CMI in 2026E-2028E, and our constructive long-term view of the company and its runway for margin expansion.

Risks

Key risks to our target price include the following:

Further moves toward backward integration. The North American truck industry has historically used externally sourced engines from independent engine makers like Cummins. Brand loyalty by customers and the high residual value associated with these independent engines sustained their strong market shares despite attempts by manufacturers to increase vertical integration. North American manufacturers are starting to migrate toward the European model of backward integration.

Inherent volatility in end-markets. The primary end-markets into which Cummins sells are highly cyclical, particularly heavy-duty truck markets worldwide. Given the company's high degree of fixed cost leverage, a marked downturn in one of these end-markets could result in sharp decline in profitability relative to our outlook. An upturn is an upside risk.

If the impact on the company from any of these factors proves to be greater/less than we anticipate, the shares may deviate from our target price.

Sinotruk (Hong Kong)

(3808.HK; HK$35.14; 1; 28 Sep 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price for Sinotruk of HK$55.0/share is based on 15x 2026E P/E (2 standard deviation above historical average) to factor in our expectation for the company to continue outperforming in the medium term.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price include any economic slowdown and the absence of FAI improvement; weaker-than-expected fleet replacement trends; and competition.

Key upside risks to our target price include stronger-than-expected economic growth; stronger-than-expected truck sales; and FAI improvements.

Any of these factors could cause the shares to deviate from our target price.

Weichai Power

(2338.HK; HK$27.74; 1; 28 Sep 26; 16:10)

Valuation

By applying 23x 2026E PER (2SD above the historical average to factor in upside potential on data center engines earnings), we set our target price at HK$50.0.

Risks

Key downside risks to our target price and investment view on Weichai include: worse highway freight traffic and/or property FAI; decline in major customers outsourcing engine supply; and weaker US/EU logistics markets.

Key upside risks to our target price are: stronger-than-expected FAI growth; and faster-than-expected market share gain.

Any of these factors could cause the shares to deviate from our target price.

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Appendix A-1

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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Sinotruk (Hong Kong) (3808.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jeff Chung



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	23-Jan-24 11:48:16	1	*18.00	14.42
2	25-Mar-24 19:17:29	1	*24.80	20.00
3	04-Jul-24 20:48:25	1	*23.40	18.02
4	14-Jul-24 22:23:11	1	*25.60	17.94
5	22-Aug-24 17:37:01	1	*26.40	20.45
6	21-Jan-26 12:09:02	1	*39.40	32.24
7	02-Apr-26 06:45:58	1	*51.00	42.54
8	22-Jul-26 09:34:41	1	*55.00	38.64

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Weichai Power (2338.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jeff Chung



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	15-Oct-23 17:53:04	2	*11.40	11.12
2	30-Oct-23 16:20:50	2	*13.20	11.94
3	25-Mar-24 16:19:24	2	*15.40	15.28
4	29-Apr-24 16:38:39	2	*17.20	16.50
5	04-Jul-24 20:48:25	2	*14.00	12.88
6	22-Aug-24 17:28:07	2	*12.90	12.22
7	30-Oct-24 19:20:42	2	*12.60	11.88
8	30-Mar-25 23:42:48	2	*18.40	16.76
9	01-May-25 22:05:29	2	*16.30	15.20
10	10-Nov-25 04:01:02	2	*21.30	20.04
11	22-Jan-26 22:37:43	*1	*34.00	24.40
12	29-Apr-26 12:00:03	1	*42.00	36.12
13	21-Jun-26 19:22:38	1	*50.00	39.72

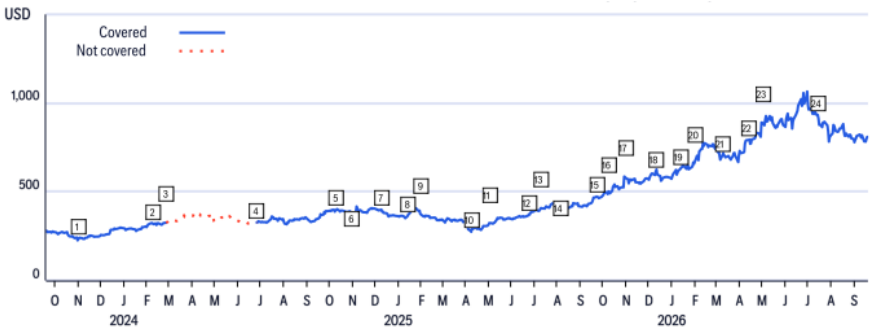
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Caterpillar Inc (CAT)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kyle Menges



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	02-Nov-23 10:38:04	2	*255.00	239.12
2	11-Feb-24 20:52:44	2	*340.00	317.16
3	26-Feb-24 16:21:48	Coverage terminated		
4	26-Jun-24 05:00:00	*1	*380.00	326.73
5	09-Oct-24 07:03:29	1	*445.00	396.19
6	31-Oct-24 04:00:00	1	*435.00	376.20
7	09-Dec-24 04:13:18	1	*460.00	399.26
8	13-Jan-25 05:00:00	1	*420.00	362.50
9	31-Jan-25 05:00:00	1	*430.00	371.44
10	08-Apr-25 05:45:00	1	*320.00	273.94
11	02-May-25 16:47:51	1	*370.00	323.68
12	23-Jun-25 16:00:58	1	*420.00	366.23
13	10-Jul-25 05:52:44	1	*460.00	408.33
14	05-Aug-25 20:41:02	1	*500.00	434.23
15	22-Sep-25 07:14:12	1	*540.00	472.10
16	07-Oct-25 05:00:00	1	*570.00	486.71
17	30-Oct-25 08:43:30	1	*670.00	583.15
18	10-Dec-25 06:49:04	1	*690.00	615.35
19	12-Jan-26 05:00:00	1	*710.00	629.77
20	30-Jan-26 05:00:00	1	*760.00	657.36
21	09-Mar-26 05:00:00	1	*785.00	704.82
22	13-Apr-26 04:32:04	1	*905.00	791.73
23	01-May-26 05:45:57	1	*1,020.00	889.67
24	13-Jul-26 04:00:00	1	*1,100.00	931.47

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Cummins Inc (CMI)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Kyle Menges



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	19-Sep-23 19:13:55	1	*275.00	234.68
2	13-Nov-23 01:47:11	1	*265.00	217.43
3	11-Feb-24 20:52:44	1	*285.00	251.78
4	26-Feb-24 16:20:04	1	*305.00	266.21
5	26-Feb-24 16:21:55	Coverage terminated		
6	26-Jun-24 05:00:00	1	*320.00	281.67
7	08-Aug-24 11:05:07	1	*330.00	297.24
8	23-Aug-24 07:03:36	1	*345.00	309.31
9	09-Oct-24 07:03:29	1	*375.00	333.05
10	20-Nov-24 05:00:00	1	*415.00	360.95
11	09-Dec-24 04:13:18	1	*435.00	383.42
12	13-Jan-25 05:00:00	1	*430.00	361.07
13	31-Mar-25 06:04:57	1	*360.00	313.44
14	08-Apr-25 05:45:00	1	*320.00	267.12
15	12-May-25 05:00:00	1	*350.00	330.59
16	23-Jun-25 16:00:58	1	*360.00	316.34
17	10-Jul-25 05:52:44	1	*380.00	340.03
18	06-Aug-25 05:32:26	1	*425.00	381.68
19	22-Sep-25 07:14:12	1	*485.00	424.85
20	07-Oct-25 05:00:00	1	*500.00	434.17
21	07-Nov-25 05:00:00	1	*530.00	473.34
22	10-Dec-25 06:49:04	1	*580.00	524.53
23	12-Jan-26 05:00:00	1	*630.00	562.18
24	13-Apr-26 04:32:04	1	*710.00	618.28
25	06-May-26 04:00:00	1	*770.00	715.76
26	13-Jul-26 04:00:00	1	*790.00	664.39

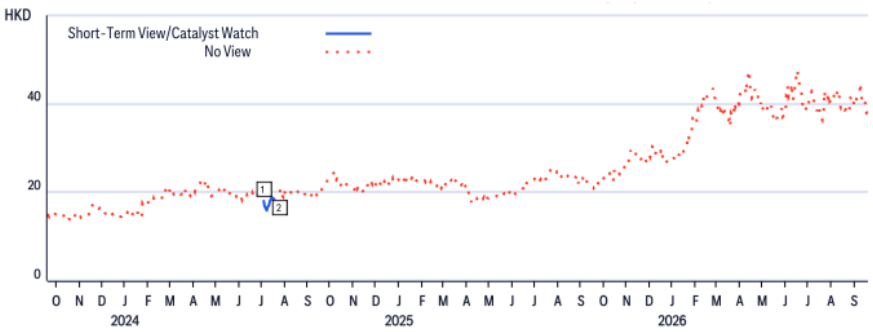
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Sinotruk (Hong Kong) (3808.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jeff Chung



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	04-Jul-24 16:48:25	Add CW	Downside	90 Days	18.02
2	25-Jul-24 20:00:57	Remove CW	Downside	90 Days	17.66

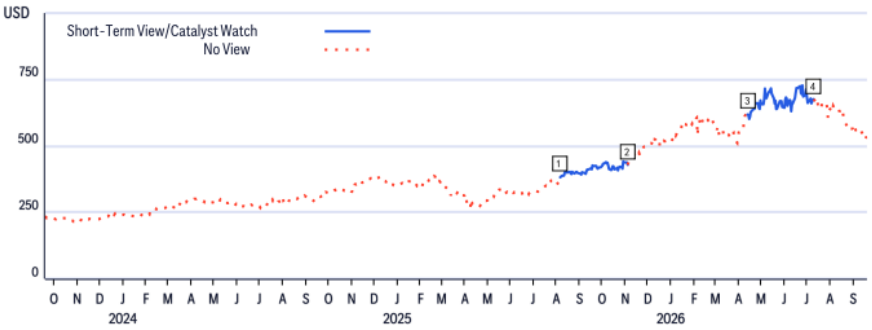
CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Cummins Inc (CMI)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kyle Menges



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	06-Aug-25 01:32:26	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	381.68
2	04-Nov-25 11:05:38	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	428.74
3	13-Apr-26 00:32:04	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	618.28
4	10-Jul-26 14:21:42	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	675.95

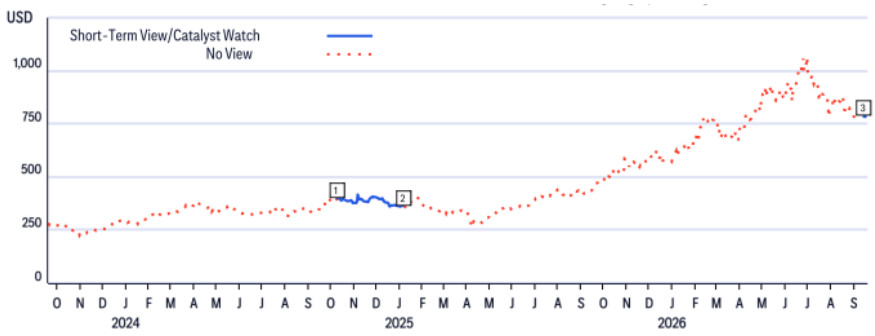
CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Caterpillar Inc (CAT)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Kyle Menges



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	09-Oct-24 03:03:29	Add STV	Downside	90 Days	396.19
2	07-Jan-25 11:28:13	Remove STV	Downside	90 Days	363.00
3	14-Sep-26 00:00:12	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	784.00

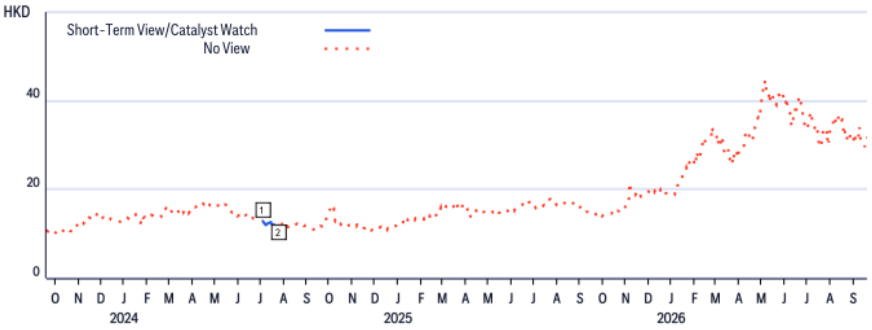
CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Weichai Power (2338.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jeff Chung



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	04-Jul-24 16:48:25	Add CW	Downside	90 Days	12.88
2	25-Jul-24 21:06:40	Remove CW	Downside	90 Days	11.66

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

The Firm has made a market in the publicly traded equity securities of Sinotruk (Hong Kong) Ltd on at least one occasion since 1 Jan 2025.

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
Data current as of 01 Jul 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**
Citi Research Global Fundamental Coverage (Neutral=Hold)	61%	32%	7%	36%	48%	16%
% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	38%	42%	27%	42%	37%	36%

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Risk rating takes into account both price volatility and fundamental criteria. Stocks will either have no risk rating or a High risk rating assigned.
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